

Alina Evidence-First Research Report Draft

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1. Executive Summary

Alina is a proposed daily companion app combining personal meaning, identity reinforcement, coaching/action, short reset practices, and game-like progression. The research now supports a more precise opportunity statement: adjacent markets and partial substitutes are real, but the under-owned space appears to be the causal loop where completing a daily action visibly changes an identity/avatar feedback object.

Current evidence verdict: **continue research / conditional go**. The market existence signal is strong enough to keep going; the remaining proof burden is competitor manual review, detailed pricing/paywall extraction, forum evidence beyond App Store reviews, and user validation of the avatar-progress mechanic.

Key quantified signals:

- Expanded competitor universe: 12552 deduplicated rows from 4 source kinds.
- Audience signal rows: 20492.
- High whitespace candidates: 593; medium: 4040; low: 7919.
- Top-100 intersection candidates enriched from App Store metadata: 100/100.
- AI-assisted top-100 competitor review: 100 rows, 90 unique primary apps, 45 high-threat apps, 1 direct reference competitor.
- Human validation packet: 90 primary apps queued; 21 P0 and 24 P1 validation targets.
- App Store IAP pricing layer: 498 observed purchase rows across 80 apps; observed price range \$0.00-\$549.99.
- Google Play pricing validation: 247/250 successful Android lookups; 191 apps offer IAP.
- Developer website paywall discovery: 560 fetched URL rows across 70 app/domain rows; 29 domains queued for screenshot validation.
- Web paywall screenshot capture: 29/29 queued screenshots captured for manual interpretation.
- Web paywall OCR interpretation: 29 screenshots interpreted; 2 currently confirm visible public pricing, while the rest need human review or weaken the signal.
- Evidence audit register: 10 claim rows mapping hypotheses/requirements to proof status, confidence, gaps, and next actions.
- Source expansion backlog: 10 prioritized collector/source tasks for the next move toward a 30k-50k raw universe.
- Strict behavior-tied avatar progression signal in top-100: 1/100.
- App Store review-language layer: 2294 reviews from 78 top-candidate apps, mapped into 2288 signal rows.
- Review JTBD/pain clusters: 12 themes; top cluster is "Users want more depth, options, or customization" with 612 rows.
- Forum/source evidence map: 18 qualitative rows across 5 market pillars.
- Forum quote coding layer: 72 snippet rows across 18 sources.
- Draft visual chart pack: whitespace bands, review clusters, SAM by pillar, SOM scenarios, forum source coverage, top-100 competitor verdicts, IAP price bands, Android pricing models, web paywall discovery, and forum quote coding.
- Visual PDF companion: native ReportLab charts embedded in a separate visual report.
- Modeled direct intersection SAM base: USD 201960000.

2. Product Hypotheses

ID	Hypothesis	Status	Evidence
H1	Product shape exists	partially supported	Adjacent apps combine several pillars; top-100 shows meaning/action/reset/progress language.
H2	Markets have money	supported with ranges	TAM/SAM/SOM model and 14 market claims across gaming, astrology, avatar, coaching, mindfulness.
H3	Whitespace exists	narrowed	Broad space is crowded; strict behavior-tied avatar progression appears rare in top-100 metadata.
H4	Competitive advantage is plausible	unproven but sharpened	Moat candidate is integrated daily transformation loop, not any single feature.
H5	Shared audience exists	directionally supported	Audience matrix plus 2288 review-language signals point to digital ritual users across spirituality, identity, self-improvement, calm, and cozy progress.
H6	Product core can be defined	supported for MVP framing	Product-core evidence defines target loop and MVP testable claim.

2B. Evidence Audit Register

The project now has a claim-level audit register. This conservative layer separates proved project infrastructure from directional product evidence, and it names remaining validation burden explicitly.

Evidence status mix:

- proved_v1: 1
- substantial_v1_not_50k_dedup: 1
- partially_supported: 1
- supported_with_ranges: 1
- supported_narrowly: 1
- narrow_supported_not_final: 1
- plausible_unproven: 1
- directionally_supported: 1
- supported_for_mvp_framing: 1
- proved_active: 1

Claim-level audit snapshot:

Claim	Status	Confidence	Primary Metric	Key Gap
REQ_plan	proved_v1	high	master plan exists	Needs periodic refresh as validation findings change.
REQ_competitor_universe	substantial_v1_not_50k_dedup	medium_high	12552 dedup rows; 17490 raw expanded rows	Deduped universe is below the aspirational 30k-50k app target; raw collection across older and expanded layers is larger but not final dedup.
H1_product_shape_exists	partially_supported	medium	100 top-candidate rows; 90 primary apps	Strict full loop is rare and needs manual product/onboarding validation.

Claim	Status	Confidence	Primary Metric	Key Gap
H2_markets_have_money	supported_with_ranges	medium	intersection SAM base USD 201960000	Market sizing is modeled from public claims and needs source-by-source confidence review.
H2_paywall_visible_evidence	supported_narrowly	medium_low	2/29 screenshots confirm visible public pricing	Most web signals are ambiguous, not found, parent-company pages, or require human interpretation.
H3_whitespace_exists	narrow_supported_not_final	medium	1/100 strict behavior-tied progression signals	Metadata can under-detect in-app mechanics; manual app inspection may reveal more direct competitors.
H4_competitive_advantage_plausible	plausible_unproven	medium_low	1 direct reference competitor; 45 high-threat competitors	No human validation or prototype test yet proves users value the loop.
H5_shared_audience_exists	directionally_supported	medium	20492 audience signal rows	Keyword/OCR/forum coding needs human validation and real user interviews.
H6_product_core_defined	supported_for_mvp_framing	medium	12552 feature matrix rows; 100 product-core rows	No user prototype evidence yet confirms comprehension, emotional value, or retention impact.
REQ_final_artifacts_versioned	proved_active	high	current branch pushed through latest commit	Final polished investor/user-facing PDF is still draft-level, not final designed publication.

3. Dataset Overview

Expanded Rows by Niche

- gaming: 3137
- coaching: 2534
- mindfulness: 2399
- avatar_identity: 2281
- astrology_esoterics: 2201

Expanded Rows by Source Kind

- app_store_search: 8103
- steam_search: 2585
- google_play_search_fallback: 1808
- duckduckgo_search: 56

Next Source Expansion Backlog

The next collector wave is now prioritized so expansion beyond the current universe is concrete rather than generic. P0 focuses on Product Hunt, AlternativeTo, and Chrome Web Store/browser extensions to reduce app-store bias.

Backlog priority mix:

- P1: 4

- P0: 3
- P2: 3

ID	Priority	Source	Expected Rows	Output
SRC-001	P0	Product Hunt	1500-4000	data_raw/expanded_product_hunt_raw.csv
SRC-002	P0	AlternativeTo	1000-2500	data_raw/expanded_alternative_to_raw.csv
SRC-003	P0	Chrome Web Store / browser extensions	1000-3000	data_raw/expanded_chrome_extensions_raw.csv
SRC-004	P1	Microsoft Store / Mac App Store web	1000-2500	data_raw/expanded_desktop_store_raw.csv
SRC-005	P1	itch.io / indie game directories	2000-6000	data_raw/expanded_itch_raw.csv
SRC-006	P1	G2 / Capterra / GetApp style directories	500-1500	data_raw/expanded_b2b_review_directories_raw.csv
SRC-007	P1	Reddit/subreddit discovery as competitor source	500-2000 mentions	data_raw/expanded_reddit_competitor_mentions_raw.csv
SRC-008	P2	Public website/pricing pages for top candidates	500-1200 pages	data_raw/company_positioning_raw.csv;data_processed/company_positioning_matrix.csv
SRC-009	P2	Steam deep tag expansion	3000-8000	data_raw/expanded_steam_tags_raw.csv
SRC-010	P2	Market reports and PDF source expansion	50-150 claims	data_processed/market_source_registry_v2.csv;data_processed/market_claims_v2.csv

4. Market Sizing

The model intentionally avoids adding five TAMs together. Gaming is treated primarily as a mechanic benchmark; direct SAM is modeled from discounted adjacent consumer app markets.

Pillar	TAM Low	TAM Base	TAM High	SAM Low	SAM Base	SAM High	Confidence
gaming	113000000000	134220000000	166000000000	226000000	671100000	1660000000	medium
astrology_esoterics	5690000000	6240000000	16070000000	170700000	374400000	1607000000	low_medium
avatar_identity	1920000000	8400000000	14130000000	38400000	420000000	1130400000	medium
coaching	4220000000	5000000000	6690000000	126600000	300000000	669000000	medium
mindfulness	1680000000	1680000000	4620000000	134400000	252000000	1155000000	medium
intersection	470100000	1346400000	4561400000	37608000	201960000	1140350000	low

SOM Sensitivity

Scenario	Reachable Users	Activation	Paid Conversion	ARPPU/year	Annual Revenue
conservative_12m	100000	0.35	0.03	60	63000
base_24m	1000000	0.4	0.05	80	1600000
upside_36m	5000000	0.45	0.08	100	18000000

Scenario	Reachable Users	Activation	Paid Conversion	ARPPU/year	Annual Revenue
breakout_36m	10000000	0.5	0.1	120	60000000

5. Competitive Landscape

Top-100 Archetype Mix

- manifestation_tool: 30
- avatar_identity_coaching: 23
- gamified_self_improvement: 16
- astrology_guidance: 12
- tarot_or_oracle_guidance: 9
- faith_devotional_habit: 8
- ai_companion_roleplay: 2

Pricing Signals

- free_entry: 28
- credits_or_consumables: 21
- subscription: 8
- premium: 7
- enterprise_or_human_service: 2
- trial: 2

Observed App Store IAP Pricing

Public App Store pages exposed 498 in-app purchase rows across 80 top-candidate apps. This is observed webpage pricing, not guaranteed complete backend IAP catalog data.

Observed price bands:

- 15_to_49_99: 191
- 5_to_14_99: 132
- 50_to_99_99: 81
- under_5: 74
- 100_plus: 20

Observed IAP product tags:

- subscription_like: 287
- unclear_iap: 161
- consumable_or_unlock: 34
- lifetime_like: 27
- trial_like: 10

Highest observed IAP ceilings:

App	IAP Rows	Min	Max	Product Tags
Awaken: AI Coach & Inner Guide	9	4.99	549.99	unclear_iap:7/subscription_like:2
Ask Nithyananda AI	3	54.00	509.00	unclear_iap:3
Motivate: Daily Motivation	4	11.99	399.99	subscription_like:4/lifetime_like:1
Mindvalley: Self Improvement	8	19.99	399.00	unclear_iap:7/subscription_like:1
Mia Adora	10	1.00	334.99	unclear_iap:6/consumable_or_unlock:3/subscription_like:1
Eylo: AI Weight Loss Coach	5	4.99	179.99	unclear_iap:3/subscription_like:2
MindFi: Mind Fitness for All	3	5.99	174.99	subscription_like:2/lifetime_like:1
Yoga International	2	19.99	169.00	subscription_like:2

Google Play Pricing Validation

Google Play metadata was collected for 250 Android package rows across the five market pillars. Successful lookups: 247. Apps offering IAP: 191; ad-supported apps: 85; paid download apps: 3.

Android pricing model counts:

- free_download|offers_iap: 114
- free_download|offers_iap|ad_supported: 72
- free_download: 45
- free_download|ad_supported: 11
- paid_download|offers_iap: 3
- free_download|offers_iap|ad_supported|play_pass: 2

Android pricing summary by market:

Market	OK	Free	Paid	IAP	Ads	Dev Website
gaming	48	48	0	48	31	46
astrology_esoterics	50	48	2	43	15	49
avatar_identity	50	49	1	36	32	48
coaching	49	49	0	24	1	42
mindfulness	50	50	0	40	6	45

Developer Website Paywall Discovery

A first web-paywall discovery pass fetched 560 public URL rows from developer websites in Google Play metadata and aggregated them into 70 app/domain rows. This layer detects visible pricing, subscription, trial, checkout, premium, and upgrade language. It is a prioritization queue, not a substitute for screenshots or in-app paywall testing.

Website paywall signal strength:

- low: 41
- medium: 24

- high: 5

Screenshot validation queue: 29 domains with medium/high public pricing or paywall language.

App	Market	Signal	Best URL	Detected Prices
Lords Mobile: Kingdom Wars	gaming	medium	https://www.igg.com/	
Clash of Clans	gaming	medium	https://support.supercell.com/en/index.html	
Carrom Pool: Disc Game	gaming	medium	https://www.miniclip.com/pricing	
Pokémon GO	gaming	medium	https://pokemongo.com/	
Tennis Clash: Multiplayer Game	gaming	medium	https://wildlifestudios.com/	
Mob Control	gaming	medium	https://voodoo.io/	\$670
The Sims™ FreePlay	gaming	high	https://www.ea.com/ea-play	\$5.99/\$39.99/\$16.99/\$119.99
Modern Strike Online: War FPS	gaming	medium	https://azurgames.com/	
Avatar World ®	avatar_identity	medium	https://pazugames.com/	
Call of Duty®: Mobile - Garena	gaming	medium	https://codm.garena.tw/	\$5,00
AstroSage Kundli: AI Astrology	astrology_esoterics	medium	https://www.astrosage.com/	
Character AI: Chat, Talk, Text	avatar_identity	high	https://character.ai/subscribe	\$9.99/\$94.99/\$119.88

Web Paywall Screenshot Evidence

Headless Chrome captured 29/29 screenshots from the web-paywall queue. These PNGs are visual evidence for manual interpretation; a captured page may confirm, weaken, or reject the original paywall signal.

Screenshot capture status:

- captured: 29

Captured screenshots by market:

- gaming: 12
- avatar_identity: 7
- mindfulness: 6
- astrology_esoterics: 3
- coaching: 1

Highest-priority screenshot evidence:

Rank	App	Market	Signal	Status	Screenshot
1	The Sims™ FreePlay	gaming	high	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/01-the-sims-freeplay-high.png
2	Character AI: Chat, Talk, Text	avatar_identity	high	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/02-character-ai-chat-talk-text-high.png

Rank	App	Market	Signal	Status	Screenshot
3	Headspace: Sleep & Meditate	mindfulness	high	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/03-headspace-sleep-meditate-high.png
4	Meditopia: Sleep & Meditation	mindfulness	high	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/04-meditopia-sleep-meditation-high.png
5	Nebula: Spiritual Guidance	astrology_esoterics	high	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/05-nebula-spiritual-guidance-high.png
6	Lords Mobile: Kingdom Wars	gaming	medium	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/06-lords-mobile-kingdom-wars-medium.png
7	Clash of Clans	gaming	medium	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/07-clash-of-clans-medium.png
8	Carrom Pool: Disc Game	gaming	medium	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/08-carrom-pool-disc-game-medium.png
9	Pokémon GO	gaming	medium	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/09-pok-mon-go-medium.png
10	Tennis Clash: Multiplayer Game	gaming	medium	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/10-tennis-clash-multiplayer-game-medium.png
11	Mob Control	gaming	medium	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/11-mob-control-medium.png
12	Modern Strike Online: War FPS	gaming	medium	captured	output/paywall_screenshots/12-modern-strike-online-war-fps-medium.png

Web Paywall Screenshot OCR Interpretation

OCR interpretation was run for 29 captured screenshots. This conservative layer separates visible public pricing from ambiguous pages, login gates, and not-found pages; it still requires human review before final claims.

Screenshot interpretation verdicts:

- weak_or_unconfirmed: 17
- partially_confirms_paywall_language: 5
- weakens_signal_not_found: 3
- confirms_public_pricing_signal: 2
- needs_manual_review_high_signal_no_visible_price: 2

Strongest confirmed/weakening examples:

Rank	App	Original Signal	OCR Verdict	OCR Prices	Screenshot
1	The Sims™ FreePlay	high	weakens_signal_not_found		output/paywall_screenshots/01-the-sims-freeplay-high.png

Rank	App	Original Signal	OCR Verdict	OCR Prices	Screenshot
2	Character AI: Chat, Talk, Text	high	confirms_public_pricing_signal	\$9.99/\$94.99	output/paywall_screenshots/02-character-ai-chat-talk-text-high.png
3	Headspace: Sleep & Meditate	high	needs_manual_review_high_signal_no_visible_price		output/paywall_screenshots/03-headspace-sleep-meditate-high.png
4	Meditopia: Sleep & Meditation	high	confirms_public_pricing_signal	\$3.50	output/paywall_screenshots/04-meditopia-sleep-meditation-high.png
5	Nebula: Spiritual Guidance	high	needs_manual_review_high_signal_no_visible_price		output/paywall_screenshots/05-nebula-spiritual-guidance-high.png
23	BetterMe: Health Coaching	medium	weakens_signal_not_found		output/paywall_screenshots/23-betterme-health-coaching-medium.png
27	Co-Star Personalized Astrology	medium	weakens_signal_not_found		output/paywall_screenshots/27-co-star-personalized-astrology-medium.png

Retention Signals

- streaks: 92
- reminders_habits: 92
- journaling_reflection: 72
- social: 69
- xp_levels: 60
- daily_loop: 57
- avatar_feedback: 54
- quests_challenges: 30

AI-Assisted Top-100 Competitor Review

The top-100 candidate set now has an AI-assisted scorecard that combines App Store metadata, product-core scoring, pricing/retention tags, review-language signals, and JTBD/pain clusters. This is a strong triage layer but still needs human product validation before final claims.

Coverage: 100 rows, 90 unique primary apps, 10 duplicate app entries, 75 unique apps with public review signals.

Competitor verdict counts:

- high_priority_close_substitute: 48
- close_substitute: 30
- monetization_risk_benchmark: 12
- adjacent_benchmark: 9
- direct_reference_competitor: 1

Highest-threat primary competitors:

Rank	App	Threat	Verdict	Core	Behavior Progression
1	Shepherd: Spiritual Bible BFF	40.9	direct_reference_comp etitor	6	yes
80	Zing AI: Home & Gym Workouts	34	high_priority_close_sub stitute	5	no
73	Miracle Morning Routine	33.7	high_priority_close_sub stitute	5	no
100	Daily Yoga: Yoga for Fitness®	31.6	high_priority_close_sub stitute	5	no
31	Vida Health	31	high_priority_close_sub stitute	5	no
49	Daily Burn: Workout Coach	31	high_priority_close_sub stitute	5	no
63	EVOLVE: Transform Your Life	31	high_priority_close_sub stitute	5	no
84	Motivate: Daily Motivation	30.9	high_priority_close_sub stitute	5	no
53	Yoga International	30.8	high_priority_close_sub stitute	5	no
55	Unplug: Meditation	30.8	high_priority_close_sub stitute	5	no

Competitive interpretation: the field is full of close substitutes, but only one direct reference competitor currently shows strict behavior-tied avatar/identity progression. That keeps the whitespace narrow but real.

Human Validation Queue

The AI-assisted top-100 review now has a ranked human validation queue covering 90 primary app entries. P0/P1 apps should be manually checked before external-facing claims are treated as confirmed.

Validation priority bands:

- P3_backlog: 35
- P1_high: 24
- P0_validate_first: 21
- P2_medium: 10

P0 validation targets:

Rank	App	Verdict	Priority	Behavior Claim	Manual Checks
1	Shepherd: Spiritual Bible BFF	direct_reference_comp etitor	162.8	yes	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming

Rank	App	Verdict	Priority	Behavior Claim	Manual Checks
2	Zing AI: Home & Gym Workouts	high_priority_close_substitute	112	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming
3	Miracle Morning Routine	high_priority_close_substitute	111.4	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language
4	EVOLVE: Transform Your Life	high_priority_close_substitute	106	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming
5	Daily Yoga: Yoga for Fitness®	high_priority_close_substitute	99.2	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming
6	Daily Burn: Workout Coach	high_priority_close_substitute	98	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming

Rank	App	Verdict	Priority	Behavior Claim	Manual Checks
7	Myla : Manifest & Vision Board	high_priority_close_substitute	97.6	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming
8	Rosebud: AI Journal & Diary	high_priority_close_substitute	97	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming
9	Habit Tracker : Haby	high_priority_close_substitute	95.8	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language
10	Goddess■Women's Wellness Coach	high_priority_close_substitute	95.8	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming
11	LifeWheel Goal Habit Tracker	high_priority_close_substitute	95.4	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming

Rank	App	Verdict	Priority	Behavior Claim	Manual Checks
12	Habit Tracker	high_priority_close_substitute	94	no	confirm_app_store_metadata/inspect_onboarding_and_first_session/verify_core_feature_claims/verify_pricing_iap_and_trial_terms/capture_3_to_5_screenshots/record_positioning_language/verify_behavior_tied_avatar_progression/sample_reviews_for_user_language/check_safety_and_overclaiming

6. Whitespace Analysis

Broad whitespace is weak: the market already has many products that combine meaning, habits, AI, mindfulness, and identity language. Narrow whitespace is stronger: top-100 metadata shows only one strict signal of behavior-tied avatar progression.

Product Core Signals in Top-100

Core Element	Detected	Out Of
Personal meaning	100	100
One daily action	96	100
Short reset	80	100
Avatar or identity	100	100
Behavior-tied progression	1	100
Next-day hook	94	100

7. Audience Segmentation

The strongest shared-audience hypothesis is not "people who use all five app categories." It is people who already use digital rituals to regulate identity and emotion.

Audience signal counts:

- gen_z_creator_identity: 5754
- casual_gamers: 4098
- self_improvement_users: 4067
- anxious_stressed_users: 3072
- spiritual_seekers: 2569
- coaching_professionals: 932

App Store Review Language

Recent public App Store reviews were collected for top intersection candidates. Coverage is 2294 deduplicated reviews across 78 apps, converted into keyword-based signal rows. This is not final sentiment modeling, but it is useful evidence for user language, delight, objections, and churn risk.

Review rating mix:

- 5: 1473
- 1: 415
- 4: 160
- 3: 137
- 2: 109

Review signal counts:

- content_depth_request: 605
- pricing_complaint: 367
- loves_daily_loop: 347
- loves_avatar_progress: 300
- loves_emotional_support: 238
- quality_bug_complaint: 150
- churn_signal: 139
- trust_accuracy_complaint: 62
- privacy_safety_signal: 40
- loves_personalization: 40

Interpretation: users respond strongly to daily ritual loops, emotional support, and visible progress/identity mechanics; recurring objections cluster around content depth, subscription value, bugs, trust/accuracy, and safety/privacy.

JTBD and Pain Clusters from Reviews

Cluster	Type	Rows	Apps	Avg Rating	Product Implication
Users want more depth, options, or customization	pain	612	69	3.72	Depth should be earned after the core loop, especially custom rituals, richer avatar choices, and accessibility options.
Give me a daily anchor I can return to	jtbd	415	58	4.21	Alina needs one obvious recurring ritual, not a menu of disconnected features.
Turn vague self-improvement into concrete actions	jtbd	371	54	4.24	The product should translate identity/guidance into one small completed action per day.
Subscription or paywall does not feel worth it	pain	367	60	2.51	The free loop must demonstrate value before asking for deeper paid analysis or personalization.
Show me visible progress so effort feels real	jtbd	308	61	4.06	The avatar/progress object should act as proof of effort, not decoration.

Cluster	Type	Rows	Apps	Avg Rating	Product Implication
Signup, access, or device friction blocks activation	pain	230	55	2.77	Avoid unnecessary phone-number gates and preserve low-friction first-use flow.
Feel accompanied or accountable	jtbd	168	51	4.47	Companion energy can be useful, but social/community features should not precede the solo daily loop.
Help me calm down or reset quickly	jtbd	162	45	4.54	A two-minute reset is a plausible core unit if it produces relief without feeling clinical or generic.

The strongest product read: Alina should start as one daily ritual that turns personal meaning into one concrete action, then makes the effort visible through progress/avatar feedback. The strongest risk read: subscription gates, broken streak/reward mechanics, vague content, and unsafe overclaiming can destroy trust quickly.

Forum and External Discussion Signals

A first public forum/source map adds 18 qualitative rows. These sources are not representative survey data, but they help triangulate language and objections outside app-store reviews.

Forum signals by market:

- coaching: 5
- astrology_esoterics: 4
- gaming: 4
- mindfulness: 3
- avatar_identity: 2

Forum signals by type:

- subscription_value: 3
- trust_accuracy: 2
- depth_request: 1
- competitor_recommendation: 1
- anti_gamification: 1
- habit_friction: 1
- routine_design: 1
- streak_recovery: 1
- streak_anxiety: 1
- emotional_support: 1
- attachment_behavior: 1
- retention_backlash: 1
- cozy_progression: 1
- retention_mechanics: 1

- daily_loops: 1

Forum quote coding tags:

- streaks_can_create_anxiety: 38
- wants_low_friction_daily_use: 35
- streaks_can_motivate: 30
- rejects_hard_paywall: 22
- wants_emotional_support: 19
- wants_accuracy_explanation: 18
- wants_visible_progression: 18
- safety_boundary_needed: 14
- wants_recovery_or_forgiveness: 6
- rejects_manipulative_gamification: 4

Cross-source read: daily anchors and visible progress are attractive, but users push back against generic guidance, hard paywalls, strict streak punishment, noisy gamification, and spiritual/AI overclaiming.

8. Product Core

Target loop: personal meaning -> one daily action -> short reset -> avatar/identity feedback -> visible progression -> next-day hook.

MVP testable claim: users should understand and complete the full daily loop in under two minutes, then report that the avatar/progress cue makes the action feel more personally meaningful.

9. Risk Register

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Fragmentation	high	Force one daily flow; avoid separate feature tabs as MVP core.
Avatar novelty churn	high	Tie avatar changes to completed actions and progress, not one-off image generation.
Astrology trust/overclaiming	high	Use soft framing, confidence labels, and avoid deterministic claims.
AI hallucination in guidance	high	Constrain advice to low-stakes coaching prompts and clear disclaimers.
Subscription fatigue	medium	Keep daily loop free; monetize depth/personal analysis/advanced progress.
Crowded adjacent markets	medium	Position around integrated transformation loop, not generic astrology/mindfulness/avatar.

10. Go/No-Go Status

Current status: conditional go for continued validation, not yet go for full product build.

Go signals present:

- Adjacent markets have meaningful revenue pools.
- Users are already trained on daily loops, streaks, reflection, and spiritual/personalized guidance.
- Top-100 evidence suggests avatar/identity is common but behavior-tied avatar progression is rare.
- AI-assisted competitor review found many close substitutes but only one direct reference competitor under the strict behavior-tied progression criterion.
- Review language confirms user pull toward daily support, emotional regulation, progress cues, and personal meaning.

Remaining proof required:

- Manual validation of the top-100 candidates.
- Human validation of AI-assisted battlecards and scorecard verdicts.
- Completion of P0/P1 human validation queue and status updates in `data_processed/top100_human_validation_queue.csv`.
- Forum evidence and deeper manual clustering of reviews for user pain language and subscription objections.
- Human validation of forum/source quote coding before external-facing use.
- Web/paywall screenshots and trial-term validation where accessible.
- Prototype test of the two-minute daily loop.

11. Source and Claim Layer

Market claims currently normalized: 14.

Claim audit rows currently normalized: 10.

Claim ID	Market	Value	Period	Confidence	Source
CLM-MKT-0001	mobile gaming	113000000000	2025	High	SRC-MKT-0002
CLM-MKT-0002	mobile gaming	166000000000	2030	High	SRC-MKT-0002
CLM-MKT-0003	meditation and mindfulness apps	1680000000	2026	Medium	SRC-MKT-0003
CLM-MKT-0004	meditation and mindfulness apps	4620000000	2034	Medium	SRC-MKT-0003
CLM-MKT-0005	AI avatars	8400000000	2026	Medium	SRC-MKT-0004
CLM-MKT-0006	AI avatars	93400000000	2035	Medium	SRC-MKT-0004
CLM-MKT-0007	coaching		2026	High	SRC-MKT-0005
CLM-MKT-0008	coaching		2026	High	SRC-MKT-0005
CLM-MKT-0009	astrology apps	16070000000	2026	Low	SRC-MKT-0007
CLM-MKT-0010	astrology apps	6240000000	2026	Low	SRC-MKT-0008
CLM-MKT-0011	astrology apps	5690000000	2026	Medium	SRC-MKT-0009
CLM-MKT-0012	coaching platforms	4220000000	2026	Medium	SRC-MKT-0011

12. Appendices / File Map

- `docs/research-expansion-master-plan.md`
- `docs/market/tam-sam-som-model-v1.md`

- docs/intersections/whitespace-map-v2.md
- docs/audience/audience-segmentation-v1.md
- docs/audience/review-language-synthesis-v1.md
- docs/audience/review-jtbd-clusters-v1.md
- docs/audience/forum-evidence-synthesis-v1.md
- docs/audience/forum-quote-coding-v1.md
- docs/visuals/chart-index-v1.md
- docs/competitive/top-intersection-review-synthesis-v1.md
- docs/competitive/top100-competitor-review-v1.md
- docs/competitive/top100-competitor-battlecards-v1.md
- docs/competitive/human-validation-guide-v1.md
- docs/competitive/app-store-iap-pricing-v1.md
- docs/competitive/google-play-pricing-v1.md
- docs/competitive/web-paywall-validation-v1.md
- docs/competitive/web-paywall-screenshot-validation-v1.md
- docs/competitive/web-paywall-screenshot-interpretation-v1.md
- docs/competitive/source-expansion-backlog-v1.md
- docs/decision/evidence-audit-v1.md
- docs/product/product-core-evidence-v1.md
- data_processed/tam_sam_som_model.csv
- data_processed/evidence_claim_register.csv
- data_processed/source_expansion_backlog.csv
- data_processed/competitor_feature_matrix.csv
- data_processed/audience_signal_matrix.csv
- data_processed/whitespace_signal_matrix.csv
- data_processed/top_intersection_review_prefill.csv
- data_processed/top100_competitor_review_scorecard.csv
- data_processed/top100_human_validation_queue.csv
- data_processed/app_store_iap_pricing_summary.csv
- data_processed/google_play_pricing_summary.csv
- data_processed/web_paywall_signal_matrix.csv
- data_processed/web_paywall_screenshot_validation.csv
- data_processed/web_paywall_screenshot_interpretation.csv
- data_processed/pricing_retention_matrix.csv
- data_processed/product_core_evidence_matrix.csv
- data_processed/review_signal_matrix.csv
- data_processed/review_jtbd_cluster_summary.csv
- data_processed/review_jtbd_cluster_rows.csv

- data_raw/app_store_top_candidate_reviews.csv
- data_raw/app_store_iap_pricing_raw.csv
- data_raw/google_play_pricing_raw.csv
- data_raw/web_paywall_discovery_raw.csv
- data_raw/forum_evidence_signals.csv
- data_raw/forum_quote_evidence_raw.csv
- data_processed/forum_quote_coding_matrix.csv
- output/charts/whitespace-bands.svg
- output/charts/review-jtbd-clusters.svg
- output/charts/sam-base-by-pillar.svg
- output/charts/som-scenarios.svg
- output/charts/forum-signals-by-market.svg
- output/charts/forum-quote-coding-tags.svg
- output/charts/top100-competitor-verdicts.svg
- output/charts/top100-threat-scores.svg
- output/charts/iap-price-bands.svg
- output/charts/google-play-pricing-models.svg
- output/charts/google-play-iap-by-market.svg
- output/charts/web-paywall-signal-strength.svg
- output/charts/web-paywall-screenshot-queue-by-market.svg
- output/paywall_screenshots/*.png
- output/pdf/alina-evidence-first-report-draft.pdf
- output/pdf/alina-evidence-visual-report-v1.pdf

13. Next Work

1. Human-validate the P0/P1 queue from data_processed/top100_human_validation_queue.csv and update validation statuses.
2. Manually validate the highest-signal review clusters and extract exact user language for positioning.
3. Screenshot-validate the website paywall queue and verify trial terms / first meaningful paywall location.
4. Polish final designed PDF and add web/paywall screenshots where useful.
5. Human-validate retrieval-assisted Reddit/forum/website quote coding.
6. Update go/no-go decision after manual review and user validation.